TELE SALES ESSENTIALS

Tele Sales Essentials — Day 4: Objections, the Pause and A.R.T.

Study guide · Self-study

Day 4: Objections, the Pause and A.R.T.

How to Use This Guide

An objection is not a rejection. It is the client telling you, in the only words they have, what still stands between them and a decision. Today you learn what to do in the few seconds after those words arrive. That short window decides whether the call becomes a sale, a booking, or a polite goodbye.

Read this guide alone, at your own pace. Keep your phone next to you. Every exercise works if you do not have a tele sales job yet: call a friend and role-play, record yourself, or use the fictional customers in these pages. If you do work in tele sales, you may practice with real calls, but never write down real names, numbers or personal data.

Do the "What Would You Say?" exercises before you read the Model Answers. Write your answer first. The model answers are examples, not scripts. Your words should sound like you.

One rule before you start: today you practice objections only. Never promise a price, discount or exception outside your authority, and always follow local law and company policy on what you may offer and on do-not-call requests.

Today's Objectives (KASU)

Knowledge: You will know why the Mandatory Pause before an answer calms a call, and the three steps of A.R.T., MEDJAY's own framework for objections: Acknowledge, Reframe, Transition.

Attitude: You will treat an objection as information and a sign of interest, not as an attack, and you will stop rushing to defend.

Skill: You will be able to answer the four most common phone objections using the Mandatory Pause and the full A.R.T. chain, ending each one with an open how or what question.

Upskill: You will be able to take three objections in a row without losing your pace or your calm, and to recognize and respect a firm no on the spot.

Why the Instant Answer Fails

Think about the last time you objected to something on the phone. Perhaps a plan offered more data than you needed, or a subscription cost more than you expected. You said your objection, and then the person on the other end started talking immediately. How did that feel?

Most people feel pushed. The instant reply sounds rehearsed, and it tells you the other person was waiting to speak rather than listening. Your guard goes up. You repeat the same objection, louder. This is the pattern you are about to break.

There is a second reason the instant answer fails. When you answer fast, you answer the objection you expected, not the one you were given. "It's too expensive" can mean many things: the price is above their budget, they do not see the value, they are comparing it to a cheaper provider, or they simply want to know if you will move. If you reply in half a second, you pick one meaning and gamble on it.

So before you learn the words, learn the gap. Everything else today stands on it.

The Mandatory Pause

The Mandatory Pause (MEDJAY adaptation, based on Voss and Raz) is a required pause of a few seconds after the client states an objection or asks a hard question, before you speak again.

Why a few seconds? Three things happen in that gap, and all three work for you.

First, your own system settles. Under sudden pressure, your body reacts before your mind does: the breath shortens, the voice rises, the urge to fill the silence grows. A pause lets that wave pass. You have already learned the Physiological Sigh for settling nerves before a session. The Mandatory Pause is the same idea inside a live call: one slow breath, then answer.

Second, silence signals calm, not doubt. A seller who goes quiet for a moment after hard words sounds like someone who has heard this before and is not rattled. A seller who fires back instantly sounds like someone who needs this sale. Clients read the difference in the first second, and they trust the calm one. Research on vocal confidence points the same way (Guyer et al., 2019): how you sound shapes how persuasive you are judged to be, sometimes more than what you say.

Third, the pause creates room for the client to keep talking. On the phone, most people cannot stand a silence, so they fill it. Often they fill it with the real reason. "It's too expensive. Well, the last plan we had promised the same thing and it didn't work out." That second sentence is worth more than the first.

How long is a few seconds? Long enough that you notice it, short enough that it does not feel strange. Count two slow breaths in your head if you need to, then speak. During the pause, let your face relax. They cannot see you, but they can hear a tight jaw.

One caution: the pause is not a trick to make the client uncomfortable. If the silence turns heavy, a short acknowledgment fills it. "That's fair." Then continue. You will use this pause before every A.R.T. chain in this guide.

Practice example: You are calling a fictional client, a small business owner named Marta, about a booking service for her bakery. You have explained it, and she says, "That sounds expensive." You pause, take one slow breath, and hear her add, "I already pay for two other tools and I'm not sure this replaces either." Now you know the real objection. It is not the price. It is whether it replaces what she already pays for.

> **NOTES**
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> Record yourself pausing after an objection. Most learners find their "few seconds" is barely one. Practice until it feels like two.

A.R.T.: Acknowledging, Reframing and Transitioning

A.R.T. is MEDJAY's own framework for handling objections and concerns. It has three steps, and it is always used as one chain, in order. The Mandatory Pause comes before the A.

A stands for Acknowledge. Label the client's feeling, with no "but" after it. The moment you say "I understand, but...", the client stops hearing you. "But" erases the acknowledgment. So say only the

acknowledgment. "That makes sense." "I'd feel the same." "It's a real concern." Naming a feeling out loud calms it, which is why a plain label does more for the call than any defense of your product.

R stands for Reframe. Shift the decision criterion from the visible cost to the cost of inaction. Do not defend features. This is the hardest step for new reps, because the instinct is to list everything the offer includes. Resist it. If the client says the price is high, defending the features confirms that price is the thing to judge. Instead, move the question: what does staying on the current setup cost them, in money, time or results? What changes if nothing changes?

A reframe is honest. You are not pretending the price is low. You are helping the client weigh the whole decision, including the cost of delay. Research on framing shows that the same facts feel different depending on how the choice is described, and research on loss shows that people weigh losses more heavily than equal gains (Kahneman, 2011). Use that knowledge to make the full picture visible, not to invent one.

T stands for Transition. Ask an open how or what question. Never a yes/no question, never a trade or a concession. "What would need to be true for this to be worth it?" "How does that compare with how you handle it now?" The open question hands the decision back to the client with your new frame inside it.

There is one more credit worth knowing. Teaching the client something new, rather than repeating what they already believe, is the heart of what Dixon and Adamson called the Challenger approach. Your reframe is the smallest version of that idea on a phone call.

Here is the full chain, once, so you can hear its shape.

Practice example: A fictional client, a mobile plan customer named Deniz, says, "I already have a provider, and the price is fine." Pause. Acknowledge: "That makes sense. Switching when things are fine is a hassle." Reframe: "The thing I'd think about is what happens when you travel and the data runs out, since that's the cost you can't see on the monthly bill." Transition: "What would need to be true for a second look to be worth it for you?"

> **NOTES**
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> Write each step of A.R.T. on one line before you practice. Do not merge Acknowledge with Reframe. The moment you add "but", you have skipped the A.

The Four Objections You Will Hear Most

Now apply the chain, with its pause, to the four objections that fill most calls.

Price: "It's too expensive."

Pause. Acknowledge: "I hear you. It's a real number." No "but." Reframe: do not defend. Move to the cost of inaction. "The question I'd ask is what the current setup costs you over a year, counting what it doesn't cover." Transition: "What would need to change in the numbers for this to make sense?"

Price is rarely a final statement about what someone can pay. It usually means the weight of the decision feels bigger than the value they can see. You are changing what they compare against, not the price itself.

Send me an email: "Just send me the details."

Pause. Acknowledge: "Of course, I can do that." Reframe: "The problem with a brochure is it can't answer your question. My guess is you'd want to know one or two specific things." Transition: "What would you most want the email to cover?"

This objection is often a polite exit, a reflex, not a decision. If you simply send the email, the conversation is over. If you take it seriously and ask what would make it useful, you often get one more minute, and one real question.

I'll think about it: "I need to think it over."

Pause. Acknowledge: "That's fair. It's your decision." Reframe: "Thinking it over usually means there's one thing not settled yet. The cost of waiting can be that the offer or the timing moves." Transition: "What's the part you'd most want to think through?"

"I'll think about it" usually hides a specific unanswered question. Find it, and the client often answers it with you rather than alone.

I already have a provider: "We're already with someone."

Pause. Acknowledge: "That makes sense. You don't fix what isn't broken." Reframe: "The question I'd ask is not whether they're fine, but what they leave uncovered or what they charge for things you don't use." Transition: "What would need to be different for it to be worth comparing?"

Notice what never appears in any of these: a defense of your features, a discount, or a yes/no question. A.R.T. moves the conversation, it does not win an argument.

> **NOTES**
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> The most common mistake is a weak Acknowledge. "I understand" alone sounds like a script. Use a sentence you would actually say.

Discount Requests, Authority and a Firm No

Sometimes the client does not object. They ask; "Can you do something on the price?" This is not an objection, and it is not a reason to start cutting. If you give a discount for nothing, you teach the client that your first price was not real, and they will ask again.

Two rules keep you safe. First, know your authority before the call. What can you adjust, and what needs approval? Never promise a price, a discount or an exception outside your authority, and never guess at what might be approved. The answer "I can't move on that, but here's what I can do" is a complete answer. Second, when you do have room, treat it as a trade, not a gift. If you give something, ask for something of equal value in return: a longer commitment, a faster decision, a smaller scope. This is negotiation, not A.R.T., so here you trade instead of asking an open question.

And a real no? A clear "I'm not interested, please stop calling" is not an objection. It is a decision, and you respect it immediately. Thank them, end the call politely, and log the do-not-call request straight away, exactly as your policy requires. Dishonest sellers argue with a no. Professionals know that a no respected today is the only chance of a yes later, and breaking contact rules can end a career before it starts.

Practice example: A fictional client asks for a lower price on an internet plan you are authorized to offer at a set rate. You say, "I can't move on the rate. What I can do is align the start date so you aren't paying for a week you don't use. Would that help?" This is a small, real trade, not a discount, and it stays inside your authority.

> **NOTES**
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> Memorize your authority limits before your first real call. Saying "let me check" on a price is fine. Saying "I'm sure we can do something" is not.

Apply It in Your Role

Outbound sales: before each session, list the three objections that fit your offer best and write one A.R.T. chain for each. During the call, let the pause do the work. You will hear the real reason in the gap.

Inbound sales: the caller already wants something, so objections arrive later, often at price. Use the same pause and the same chain. Your reframe can lean on what they told you at the start of the call.

B2B meeting booking: your most common objection is "send me an email" or "I'm too busy." The same chain applies. Reframe around the cost of a problem left unsolved, then ask what would make a short meeting worthwhile.

No job yet: answer the phone for a week and notice how sellers handle your objections. Which ones defend? Which ones pause? Which ones ask a real question? Keep a short private list, no names, and copy the best behavior in your next role-play.

What Would You Say?

Write your answer to each before reading the Model Answers.

1. A client says, "Honestly, it's more than I wanted to spend." Write your pause, Acknowledge, Reframe and Transition. The Transition must be an open how or what question.

2. A client says, "Just email me something." Write the full A.R.T. chain, and keep it short.

3. A client says, "I'll think about it." Write the chain, and make your Reframe about the cost of waiting.

4. A client asks for a discount you are not allowed to give. Write what you say, and what you offer instead.

5. A client says firmly, "Take me off your list." Write your last two sentences, and what you log.

Key Takeaways

An objection is information and a sign of interest, not an attack.

The Mandatory Pause comes before every answer: it calms you, signals calm to the client, and often pulls out the real reason.

A.R.T., MEDJAY's own framework, runs as one chain: Acknowledge with no "but", Reframe toward the cost of inaction without defending features, Transition with an open how or what question.

Never answer an objection with a discount or a yes/no question.

A firm no is respected and logged at once, with do-not-call requests handled immediately.

Know your authority before the session, and trade rather than concede when you have room.

Quiz

Answer all five questions. Choose one option each. Write your answers down before you check them.

1. What comes right before Acknowledge in A.R.T.?
   - **A.** The Mandatory Pause
   - **B.** A discount offer
   - **C.** A summary of the features
   - **D.** A yes/no question
2. Which sentence is a correct Acknowledge?
   - **A.** "I understand, but let me explain the value."
   - **B.** "That's fair. It's a real concern."
   - **C.** "You're actually wrong about the price."
   - **D.** "Shall I send the contract?"
3. What should the Reframe step do?
   - **A.** Defend the product's features
   - **B.** Lower the price
   - **C.** Shift the decision from visible cost to the cost of inaction
   - **D.** Ask the client to decide today
4. Which Transition fits A.R.T.?
   - **A.** "Would you like to sign up?"
   - **B.** "Can I send you the details?"
   - **C.** "What would need to be true for this to be worth it?"
   - **D.** "Is the price your only concern?"
5. A client says firmly, "Take me off your list." What do you do?
   - **A.** Ask one more open question

B. Offer a discount to keep them

C. Call back tomorrow

D. Respect it, end politely and log the do-not-call request immediately

Upskill Challenge

This week, take three objections in a row with a friend on the phone: price, "send me an email" and "I'll think about it." Use a fictional customer of your own, such as a mobile plan buyer or a small business owner. Ask your friend to object in their own words, not from a list.

Rules for the drill. Pause before every answer, long enough that you notice it. Use the full A.R.T. chain each time, in order, with no "but." End every Transition with an open how or what question. Record the call if your friend agrees.

Then listen back and score yourself out of five: did I pause, did I acknowledge with no "but", did I avoid defending features, was my Transition an open question, did my voice stay calm and slow. Repeat the drill until you score four or more twice in a row. No friend available? Record yourself alone: state the objection in your own voice, pause, then answer.

Before your next practice, also write out your authority limits: what you may offer and what needs approval. Keep it to one line.

Model Answers

These are examples, not scripts. What matters is the principle behind each answer.

1. "It's more than I wanted to spend." Pause. "That makes sense. Nobody wants to stretch the budget." Reframe: "The question I'd ask is what the current setup costs you over a year, counting the gaps." Transition: "What would need to be true for this to fit what you planned to spend?" Why it works: the Acknowledge names the feeling honestly, the Reframe moves to cost of inaction, and the Transition is an open question.

2. "Just email me something." Pause. "Of course, I can send it." Reframe: "The trouble is a brochure can't answer the one thing you actually need to know." Transition: "What would you most want it to cover?" Why it works: you accept the request without ending the call, and the open question invites one more real exchange.

3. "I'll think about it." Pause. "That's fair. It's your call." Reframe: "Thinking it over usually means one thing isn't settled, and waiting can cost you the timing." Transition: "What's the part you'd most want to think through?" Why it works: you surface the hidden question instead of letting the client leave with it.

4. "I can't move on the rate. That's outside what I'm able to offer." Then, if you have room: "What I can do is a small trade, like aligning the start date so you're not paying for time you don't use. Would that help?" Why it works: you stay honest about your authority and trade rather than concede.

5. "Understood. I'll take you off the list now. Thank you for your time." Log the do-not-call request immediately, exactly as policy requires. Why it works: a firm no is a decision, and respecting it protects the client and your right to make the next call.

Quiz answers:

1. A. The Mandatory Pause is required before you answer, so the chain starts after it.

2. B. Acknowledge labels the feeling with no "but" after it.

3. C. The Reframe moves the client from visible cost to the cost of inaction and does not defend features.

4. C. A.R.T.'s Transition is always an open how or what question, never a yes/no close.

5. D. A firm no is respected and logged at once, with do-not-call requests handled immediately.

References

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